CIE-2: Visual Element Exploration

Topic:
Views & Likes as the New Age Currency

This visual exploration examines how digital interfaces represent engagement metrics such as views, likes, followers, and ratings as indicators of value. The selected elements focus on UI/UX patterns, data visualization, and interaction systems that reinforce the idea of attention functioning as a form of currency.

The final outcome will be designed as a **dashboard-style landing page interface**, where these visual elements will be integrated to simulate a real digital environment and enhance the conceptual impact.

TYPOGRAPHY (NUMBERS DOMINANCE):

The typography emphasizes large numerical values over descriptive text. Oversized numbers such as follower counts dominate the interface, visually reinforcing how digital identity and influence are quantified. This prioritization reflects the idea that engagement metrics function as a measurable form of value.

Relevance to Concept:
This reinforces the idea that engagement metrics function as currency by visually prioritizing numbers as indicators of value, influence, and digital presence.

Rationale & Justification:
Large-scale typography ensures immediate attention and establishes hierarchy, making numerical data more dominant than descriptive text. This reflects how platforms assign importance to measurable engagement.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Users are naturally drawn to larger and bolder elements first. This visual hierarchy guides attention and shapes perception, reinforcing the importance of numerical data.

Colour System (Dark UI & Highlighted Metrics)

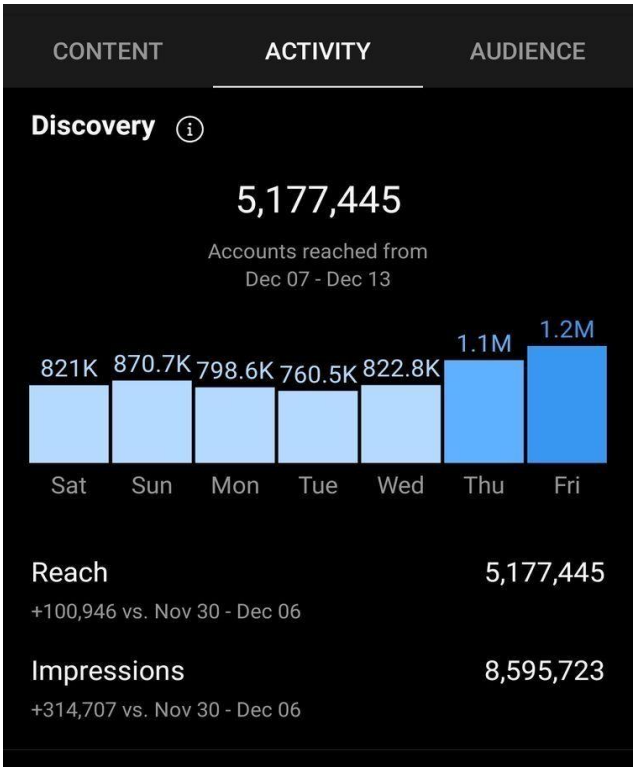
Colour System – Visual Hierarchy through Contrast
The interface uses a dark background with high-contrast highlights such as blue, purple, or white for metrics. This creates strong visual emphasis on numerical data, making engagement values stand out prominently.

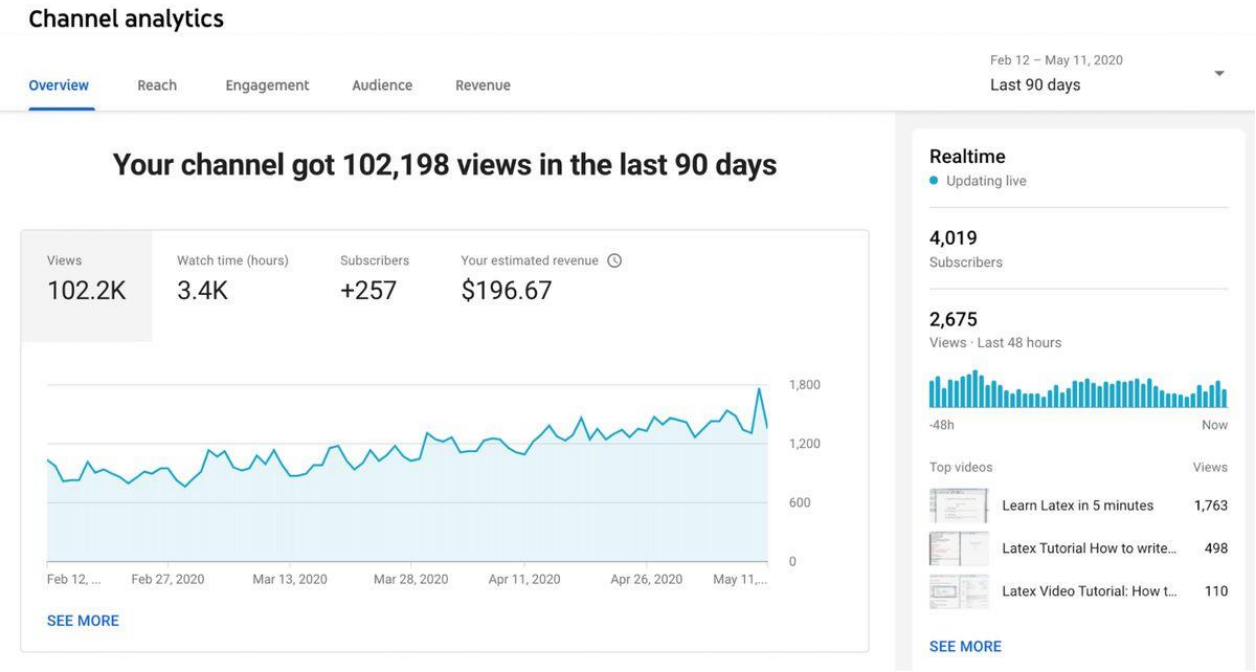
Relevance to Concept:
The contrast between dark backgrounds and bright metrics reinforces the idea of engagement values as important and attention-worthy, similar to financial figures.

Rationale & Justification:
Dark UI reduces visual noise while allowing key data points to become more prominent and visually dominant.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
High contrast directs user attention immediately to important elements, shaping perception and prioritizing numerical information.

Data Visualization (Graphs)





Data Visualization – Performance Tracking

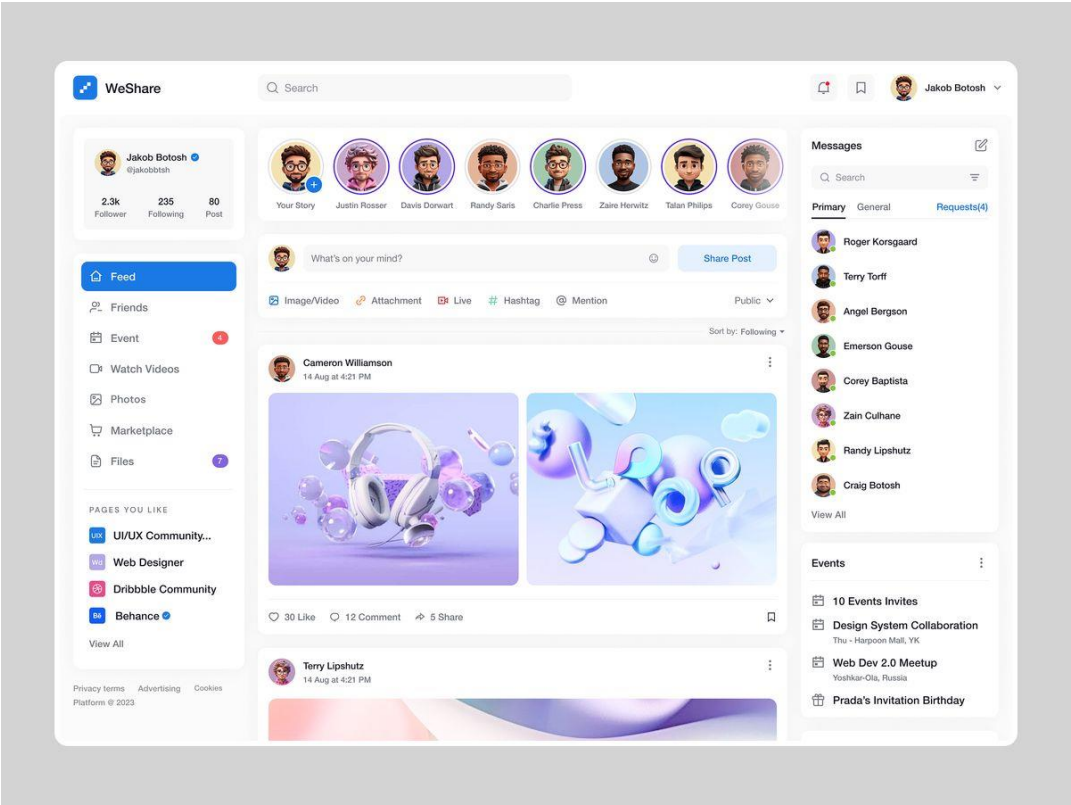
Graphs such as bar charts and line charts represent engagement trends over time. These visual elements convert user activity into measurable performance indicators, reinforcing the perception of growth, reach, and value. This aligns with the concept of metrics behaving like dynamic currency.

Relevance to Concept:
Graphs reinforce the idea of metrics as currency by presenting engagement as dynamic and measurable value that fluctuates over time.

Rationale & Justification:
Using graphs allows complex engagement data to be simplified into clear visual patterns, making growth and decline instantly understandable.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Visual trends such as rising or falling lines immediately communicate performance, allowing users to interpret value quickly without reading detailed information.

UI Components (Dashboard Layout)



UI Components – Metric-Based Interface

Dashboard layouts organize engagement data into structured sections using metric cards and panels. This systemized arrangement allows easy comparison and monitoring, similar to financial dashboards. It reinforces the idea that likes, views, and followers operate as quantifiable assets.

Relevance to Concept:
The dashboard layout reflects how digital platforms structure engagement data as measurable assets, reinforcing the idea of metrics as a system of value.

Rationale & Justification:
Organizing data into cards and sections improves readability and comparison, making numerical performance easier to evaluate.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Structured layouts guide users through information in a logical sequence, helping them interpret and compare values efficiently.

This layout directly informs the final landing page design, where a dashboard-style interface will be used to simulate real engagement tracking systems.

Iconography (Symbols of Value)

Iconography – Visual Representation of Value

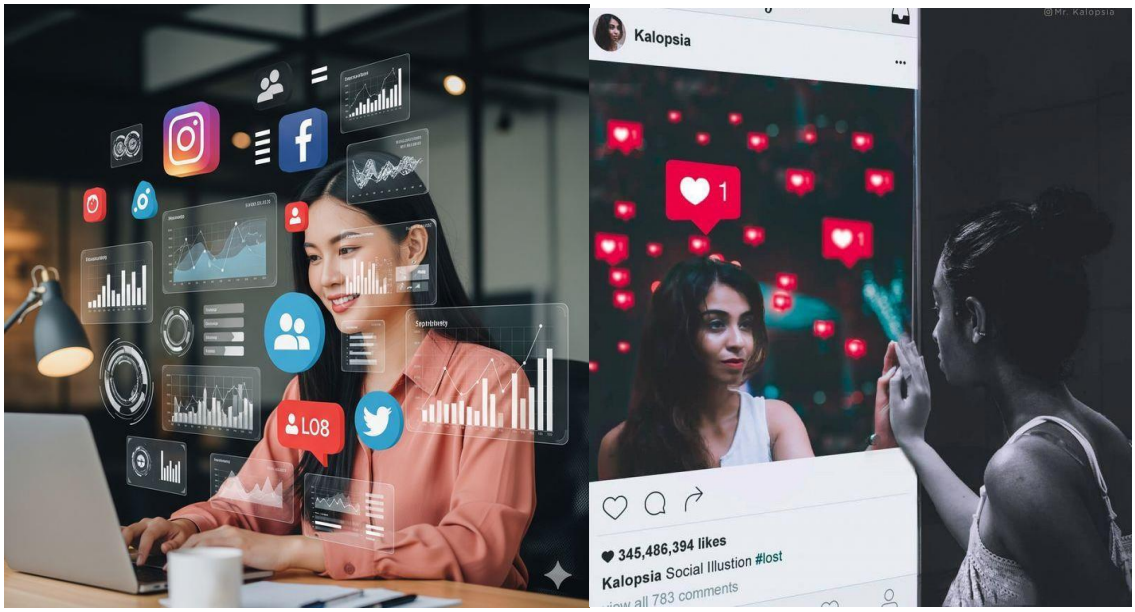
Icons such as currency symbols, growth indicators, and social media interactions simplify complex systems into recognizable visuals. These symbols establish a direct connection between financial value and digital engagement, reinforcing the concept of likes and views as currency units.

Relevance to Concept:
Icons function as visual representations of value units, linking digital engagement (likes, views) with financial symbols such as currency and growth indicators.

Rationale & Justification:
Using familiar icons simplifies complex concepts, allowing users to quickly associate engagement metrics with value and exchange.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Icons enhance recognition and reduce cognitive effort, enabling faster understanding of abstract ideas through simple visuals.

Human + Data Interaction



Human Interaction – Integration with Data Systems

The combination of human figures with floating data interfaces highlights how individuals interact with and are influenced by digital metrics. The overlay of analytics on the human subject reflects how identity is increasingly shaped by measurable engagement.

Relevance to Concept:
This element highlights how individuals are defined and evaluated through measurable engagement, reinforcing the idea of identity being shaped by digital currency.

Rationale & Justification:
Overlaying data on human figures creates a direct visual connection between people and metrics, making the concept more relatable and impactful.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Combining human imagery with data creates emotional engagement, helping users connect abstract systems to real-life experiences.

This also introduces an emotional layer, reflecting user dependence on metrics for validation and identity.

Social Validation (Likes System)

Social Validation – Quantified Approval

The visual representation of likes and reactions demonstrates how social validation is converted into numerical form. These metrics act as indicators of popularity and influence, reinforcing the idea that approval is measured and valued like currency.

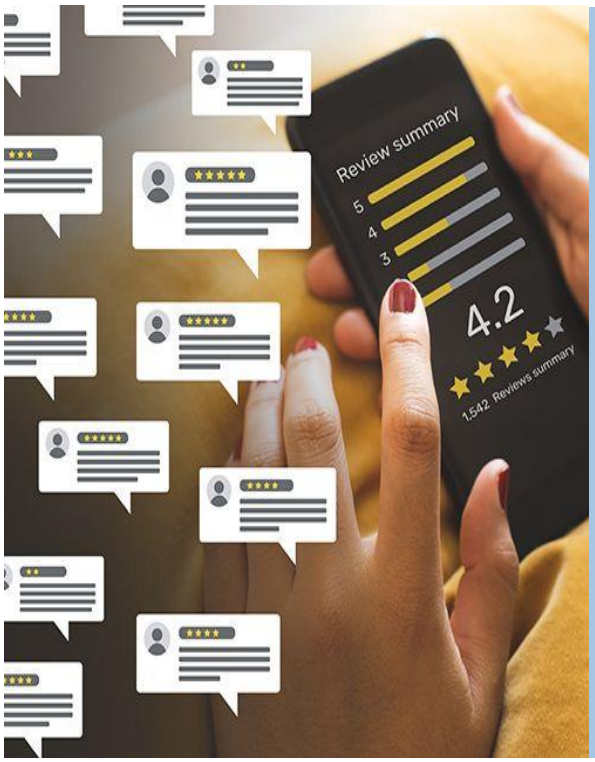
Relevance to Concept:
Likes and reactions act as measurable units of approval, reinforcing the idea that validation functions as a form of social currency.

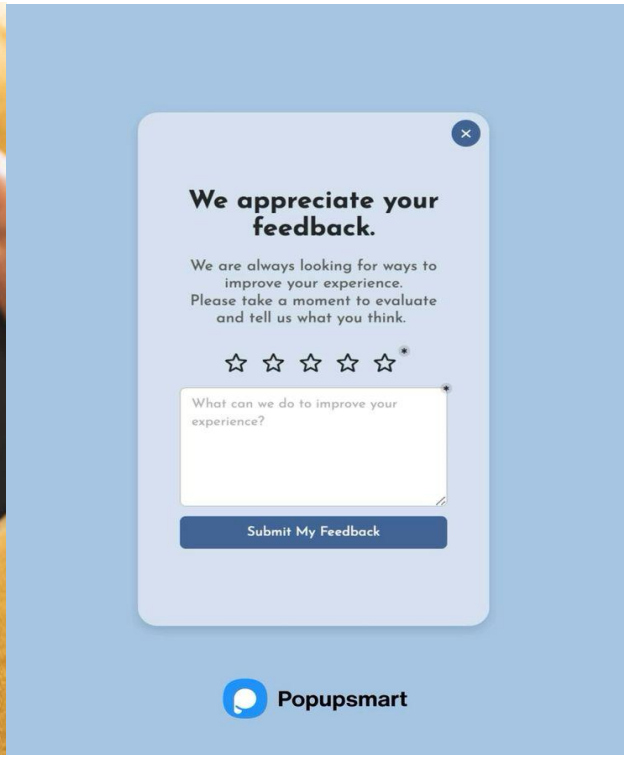
Rationale & Justification:
Displaying engagement numbers alongside content highlights their importance and influence on perception.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Users interpret higher numbers as indicators of popularity and credibility, shaping their perception of value.

This creates a sense of competition and pressure, influencing user behaviour and reinforcing dependency on numerical validation.

Rating & Feedback Systems





Rating Systems – Standardized Evaluation

Feedback systems such as star ratings and review interfaces transform subjective opinions into numerical values. This standardization reinforces the concept that user perception and experience are quantified, further supporting the idea of digital interaction as measurable currency.

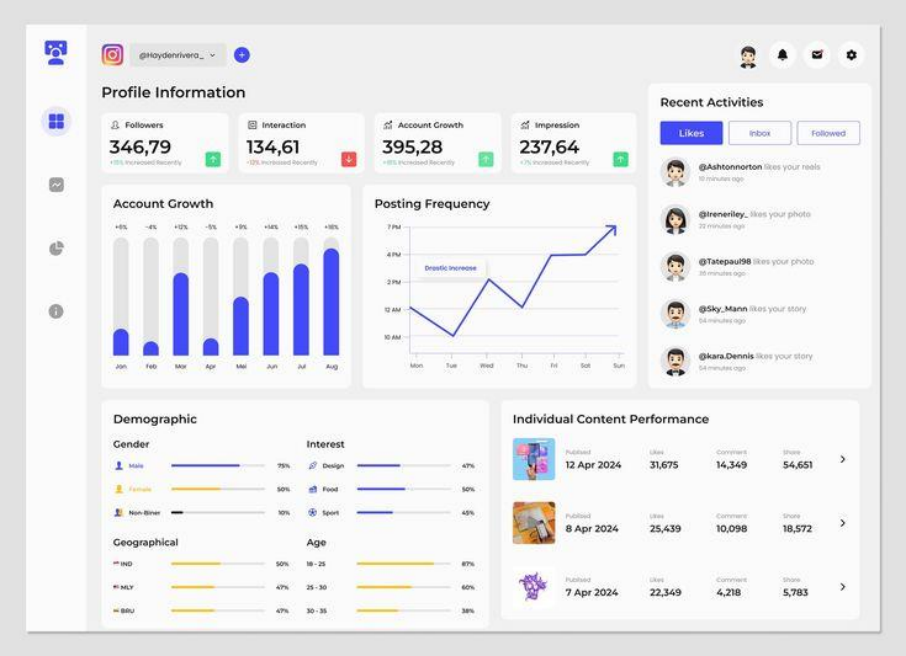
Relevance to Concept:
Ratings and reviews convert subjective opinions into numerical values, reinforcing the idea that perception and experience are quantified.

Rationale & Justification:
Standardized rating systems make evaluation easier and allow quick comparison between options.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Visual indicators like stars and scores provide immediate understanding of quality, reducing the need for detailed analysis.

This standardization reduces complex human opinions into simplified scores, reinforcing the quantification of experience.

Visual Tone (Clean Interface vs Data Overload)



Visual Tone – Structured yet Data-Heavy Interface
The interface combines clean layouts with dense information, creating a balance between clarity and overload. Multiple data points are displayed simultaneously, reflecting real digital environments.

Relevance to Concept:
This reflects how users experience constant monitoring and pressure through engagement metrics, reinforcing the idea of metrics as controlling systems.

Rationale & Justification:
Combining clean structure with high data density mirrors real-world social media dashboards and analytics platforms.

Understanding of Visual Communication:
Visual density influences user perception, creating either clarity or cognitive pressure, which affects how users interpret value.

Conclusion

The selected visual elements collectively demonstrate how digital platform's structure engagement metrics as measurable indicators of value. Through typography, data visualization, interface design, and interaction systems, views and likes are positioned as a form of currency that influences identity, visibility, and opportunity in the digital environment.

The final poster will be developed as an interactive UI/UX landing page inspired by analytics dashboards. It will incorporate metric cards, graphs, notifications, and engagement indicators to create a system-driven interface. This approach ensures that the concept is not only communicated visually but also experienced as a functional digital environment.